

NPSC CTSE 2026 — General Knowledge (Q1-43), Solved

Source: your photos of the actual paper, booklet code **26/35_A**, pages 3-7.

Q44 onwards and the English section were not in the photos.

How the answers were checked:

-  = current-affairs answer confirmed by a web source (listed at the end)
- ✓ = standard textbook fact
-  = best answer, but the question is ambiguous or the sources disagree; the reason is given

1. The Assam Forest Dept. has initiated a project for targeted IAP management in the Khalingduar Reserve Forest as IAPs have been constricting local vegetation. What is the correct expansion of IAP?

A) Injective Agri Products B) Invasive Alien Products C) Invasive Alien Plants D) Integrated Afforestation Practices

Ans: C) Invasive Alien Plants ✓

2. The badminton tournament BWF World Championships 2026 was held in New Delhi, in August this year. India was playing host to this event for the ___ time.

A) 1st B) 2nd C) 3rd D) 4th

Ans: B) 2nd  India first hosted in 2009 (Hyderabad).

3. The Supreme Court recently praised which repealed Act as a "salutary scheme" that was neither a freebie nor an exploitation of rural workers?

A) Code of Civil Procedure, 1908 B) The BPCL (Determination of Conditions of Service of Employees) Act, 1988 C) The Levy Sugar Price Equalisation Fund Act, 1976 D) Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA)

Ans: D) MGNREGA  It was repealed from 1 July 2026 and replaced by the VB-G RAM G Act. It's the only rural-workers law among the options. (I couldn't find the exact "salutary scheme" quote.)

4. With which country did India recently sign a Memorandum of Arrangement (MoA) on Maritime Security Cooperation during talks held in New Delhi and agreed to deepen operational cooperation?

A) Canada B) France C) Japan D) South Korea

Ans: C) Japan  Signed 20 Aug 2026 (Rajnath Singh-Shinjiro Koizumi talks).

5. Who was recently elected as the new President of Bangladesh in the first contested poll for the post in 35 years?

A) Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir B) Colonel (retd) Oli Ahmed C) Khaleda Zia D) AMM Nasir Uddin

Ans: A) Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir  He won 255 votes to Oli Ahmed's 88.

6. The Supreme Court of India's landmark judgment delivered on July 29, 2026 in Vanashakti vs Union of India pertains to which mandatory legal requirement under the Environment Impact Assessment (EIA) Notification 2006, that could impact thousands of industries, infrastructure and real estate projects?

A) Setting aside a part of the CSR funds for environmental protection B) Including an environmental

surcharge in all the bills C) Planting trees in a prespecified ratio to compensate for the trees cut during construction D) Obtaining prior Environmental Clearance

Ans: D) Obtaining prior Environmental Clearance ✓ The Court held prior EC mandatory and struck down post-facto regularisation.

7. A common citizen can approach the Supreme Court of India directly to file a private case:
i. Under Article 32 when there is a clear violation of his Fundamental Right by State action.
ii. Under Article 32 seeking a writ of habeas corpus where his detention is allegedly unlawful.
iii. Where a serious issue affects the public at large, a public-spirited person may bring a PIL.
A) i and ii B) i and iii C) ii and iii D) i, ii and iii

Ans: D) i, ii and iii ✓

8. The Election Commission of India (ECI) is a constitutional body presently headed by a Chief Election Commissioner and two other election commissioners. Which of the following statements is correct about the decision-making power within the ECI?
A) The Chief Election Commissioner alone has the ultimate decision-making power. B) It is by majority vote amongst the three election commissioners only. C) Decisions must be made by consensus amongst the three election commissioners, failing which the issue must be sent to the President for advice. D) Decisions must be made by consensus amongst the three election commissioners, failing which the matter must be referred to the Supreme Court for consideration by a Bench headed by the CJI.

Ans: B) Majority vote ✓ The law says decisions are unanimous as far as possible, otherwise by majority. The SC upheld this in T.N. Seshan v. Union of India (1995).

9. Which of the following are among the primary objectives of the Govt. of India's move to make E20 (petrol containing up to 20% ethanol) the standard variety available to the public?
i. Reduce India's dependence on imported crude oil ii. Create an additional market for farmers iii. Reduce emissions
A) i and ii B) i and iii C) ii and iii D) i, ii and iii

Ans: D) i, ii and iii ✓

10. How many men's and women's teams, respectively, competed in the FIH Hockey World Cup 2026 tournament hosted by Belgium and Netherlands during August this year?
A) 32, 16 B) 16, 16 C) 24, 12 D) 24, 16

Ans: B) 16, 16 ✓

11. Under Article 356 of the Constitution of India, what are the circumstances that could lead to imposition of President's rule in a state?
i. After an election when no political party or coalition is able to command a majority
ii. When the Chief Minister loses the confidence of the Legislative Assembly and there is no realistic alternative capable of commanding its confidence
iii. When the governor of the state has lost the confidence of the President of India
A) i and ii B) i and iii C) ii and iii D) i, ii and iii

Ans: A) i and ii ✓ Statement iii is not a ground under Art. 356.

12. For how long can President's Rule under Article 356 ordinarily continue?
A) Absolute ordinary maximum duration is 3 years. B) Not more than one year. C) For whatever

duration the Parliament of India approves with absolute majority. D) For up to one year, and conditionally, beyond one year also.

Ans: D ⚠️ Beyond one year it can continue only if a National Emergency is in force and the Election Commission certifies that elections can't be held (44th Amendment). The absolute cap is 3 years, so an examiner might have meant A.

13. The responsibility of conducting the decadal census in our country rests with the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner of India, under the _____.
A) Prime Minister's Office (PMO) B) Ministry of Planning (MoP) C) Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) D) Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)

Ans: C) Ministry of Home Affairs ✓

14. The Census Act was enacted in the year _____ to provide a plan for conducting population census and lay out the duties and responsibilities of census officers in India.
A) 1947 B) 1948 C) 1956 D) 1961

Ans: B) 1948 ✓

15. The Central Government has been providing free food grains to about 81.35 crore beneficiaries under a scheme being run under the aegis of the _____.
A) Prime Minister's Office (PMO) B) M/o Consumer Affairs, Food and Public Distribution (MoCAFP) C) M/o Social Justice and Empowerment (MoSJE) D) M/o Health and Family Welfare (MoHFW)

Ans: B) Ministry of Consumer Affairs, Food & Public Distribution ✓ The scheme is PMGKAY.

16. In March 2026, the Govt. of India eased its FDI rules to allow investments from companies in which up to ____% stake is owned by entities based in countries that share land borders with India.
A) 10 B) 15 C) 25 D) 50

Ans: A) 10 ✓ Press Note 2 (2026) eased Press Note 3 (2020).

17. What is the full form of MDR, the charge which banks, payments processors, and gateways levy on merchants in India?
A) Merchant Discount Repo Rate B) Merchant Delivery Reliability Rate C) Merchant Delivery Repo D) Merchant Discount Rate

Ans: D) Merchant Discount Rate ✓

18. Presented on February 1, 2026 by the Finance Minister, Govt of India, the Union Budget 2026-27 totals an estimated expenditure of about ₹____ lakh crore.
A) 53 B) 35 C) 43 D) 33

Ans: A) 53 ✓ Total expenditure is ₹53.5 lakh crore.

19. Which of the following are among the three 'kartavyas' that inspired Govt. of India's Union Budget 2026-27?

i. Accelerate and sustain economic growth ii. Make India a global manufacturing hub iii. Fulfil aspirations of the people and build their capacity
A) i and ii B) ii and iii C) i and iii D) i, ii and iii

Ans: C) i and iii ✓ The third kartavya is inclusive access to resources and opportunities (Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas), not manufacturing.

20. What is the specific hidden environmental cost of rising dependence on artificial intelligence (AI)?

A) An invisible water footprint B) Plastic waste accumulation C) Both A and B D) None of these

Ans: A) An invisible water footprint ⚠ Data-centre cooling uses water, and that is the widely reported "hidden" cost. "Both" is arguable.

21. The National Pension System (NPS) is a voluntary, retirement savings scheme backed by Govt. of India and regulated by PFRDA. Indian citizens aged between _____ years are eligible to open an NPS account.

A) 18 to 70 B) 18 to 85 C) 21 to 65 D) 18 to 58

Ans: B) 18 to 85 ✓ PFRDA raised the entry age from 70 to 85 in Dec 2025. ⚠ Older textbooks give 18–70 (A).

22. The Dept. of Financial Services, M/o Finance, in July 2026, launched India's first sovereign-backed Protection and Indemnity insurance product under Bharat Maritime Insurance Pool (BMIP) through:

A) National Insurance Company Limited B) The Oriental Insurance Company Limited C) The New India Assurance Company Limited D) United India Insurance Company Limited

Ans: C) The New India Assurance Company Limited ✓

23. Which of the following statements about the functioning of drones is correct?

- i. A standard quadcopter has four propellers, two of which spin clockwise and two counterclockwise.
 - ii. High-end consumer drones exist that can technically travel distances of up to 15–20 km.
 - iii. For flying a consumer drone in India one needs to get a license from the local authorities.
- A) i and ii B) ii and iii C) i and iii D) i, ii and iii

Ans: A) i and ii ✓ Under Drone Rules 2021, nano and micro drones flown for non-commercial use need no licence.

24. The full form of GPS, which is a feature widely in use by smartphone users and automobile drivers:

A) Go-To Place Service B) Geometric Positioning Service C) Global Positioning System D) Geographic Position Surveillance

Ans: C) Global Positioning System ✓

25. Should a household refrigerator's temperature be varied according to seasons?

A) No, regardless of the weather the inner temperature must be maintained around 4°C or below.
B) Yes, in winters the temperature could be set higher as the cold weather keeps it cool from outside also. C) Both A and B D) None of the above

Ans: A ✓ Food-safety guidance is to keep it at 4 °C or below all year.

26. Which of the following is a primary function of the hair on the head in humans?

- i. Protect the scalp from sunlight or the cold weather
 - ii. It's an overgrowth with no identified primary function, but only has cosmetic decorative purpose
 - iii. Help regulate body temperature
- A) i and ii B) ii and iii C) i and iii D) i, ii and iii

Ans: C) i and iii ✓

27. Why are we generally advised to avoid standing under a tree during a thunderstorm?

- A) If the tree is struck by lightning, the electrical current can travel through the tree and hurt us. B) If the tree is struck by lightning, some branches will break and fall on us causing injuries. C) Both A and B D) None of the above

Ans: A ⚠ Standard safety advice gives the side-flash/current reason. Falling branches are also a real risk, so C is defensible.

28. Match the continents with their respective tallest mountains:

i. Africa ii. Antarctica iii. Australia iv. Europe

(a) Mount Kosciuszko (b) Mount Kilimanjaro (c) Mount Elbrus (d) Mount Vinson

A) i-a, ii-b, iii-c, iv-d B) i-d, ii-a, iii-b, iv-c C) i-b, ii-d, iii-a, iv-c D) i-b, ii-c, iii-d, iv-a

Ans: C) i-b, ii-d, iii-a, iv-c ✓ Africa–Kilimanjaro, Antarctica–Vinson, Australia–Kosciuszko, Europe–Elbrus.

29. Which of the following is the second smallest country in the world after Vatican City?

- A) Barbados B) Grenada C) Maldives D) Monaco

Ans: D) Monaco ✓

30. What separates North Korea from South Korea?

- A) 38th Parallel B) Korean Demilitarized Zone (DMZ) C) Yellow Sea D) Han River

Ans: B) Korean Demilitarized Zone (DMZ) ✓ The 38th parallel was the 1945 dividing line. The present border is the 1953 armistice line, with the DMZ along it.

31. Which part or area of the world is called the last frontier?

- A) Alaska B) Antarctica C) Australia D) Canada

Ans: A) Alaska ✓ "The Last Frontier" is its official state nickname.

32. _____ is the largest desert in the world by geographic area.

- A) Antarctica Ice Sheet B) Arabian Desert C) Arctic Desert D) Sahara Desert

Ans: A) Antarctica ✓ (The Sahara is the largest *hot* desert.)

33. Which is the windiest place in India?

- A) Nathu La Pass, Sikkim B) Rann of Kutch, Gujarat C) Naneghat, Maharashtra D) Ramakkalmedu, Kerala

Ans: D) Ramakkalmedu, Kerala ✓

34. Which state in India has the most rivers (if you consider only the major/perennial rivers)?

- A) Uttar Pradesh B) Kerala C) Madhya Pradesh D) Gujarat

Ans: A) Uttar Pradesh ⚠ Most GK sources say UP. Some say Kerala (44 rivers) or Karnataka.

35. According to the 2011 Census, which one among the following four states has the highest population?

- A) Manipur B) Tripura C) Meghalaya D) Nagaland

Ans: B) Tripura ✓ (≈ 36.7 lakh, then Meghalaya ≈ 29.7 lakh, Manipur ≈ 28.6 lakh, Nagaland ≈ 19.8 lakh)

36. The reign of the last Mughal ruler in India, Bahadur Shah Zafar, spanned the period from ____.

A) 1837 to 1862 B) 1827 to 1857 C) 1836 to 1856 D) 1837 to 1857

Ans: D) 1837 to 1857 ✓ He was exiled to Rangoon after 1857 and died there in 1862.

37. Historically, other than the British, French and Portuguese which of the following foreign powers ruled or established colonies in some parts of what is present-day India?

i. Danish ii. Dutch iii. Russian

A) i and ii B) ii and iii C) i and iii D) i, ii and iii

Ans: A) i and ii ✓ Danish: Tranquebar and Serampore. Dutch: Pulicat, Cochin and Chinsurah.

38. Which medieval South Indian dynasty was renowned as a major maritime power?

A) Chera B) Chola C) Pallava D) Pandya

Ans: B) Chola ✓

39. The Boundary Commission chaired by Sir Cyril Radcliffe was created in July 1947 by Lord Mountbatten to recommend the division between India and Pakistan of which regions of the Indian subcontinent?

i. Bengal ii. Kashmir iii. Punjab

A) i and ii B) ii and iii C) i and iii D) i, ii and iii

Ans: C) i and iii ✓ Bengal and Punjab.

40. After India got independence in 1947, the Nightingale of India, Sarojini Naidu, became Governor of:

A) United Provinces B) Madras C) Punjab D) West Bengal

Ans: A) United Provinces ✓ She was India's first woman Governor.

41. India's first indigenous hydrogen fuel cell train was officially inaugurated on July 17, 2026 on the 89-kilometer route between __ and ____ stations.

A) Bhopal, Indore B) Delhi, Rewari C) Jind, Sonipat D) Mumbai, Pune

Ans: C) Jind, Sonipat ✓

42. Who won the Miss Universe India 2026 competition and qualified to represent the country at the 75th Miss Universe global competition, scheduled to take place in San Juan, Puerto Rico, in November 2026?

A) Manika Vishwakarma B) Kaziah Liz Mezo C) Rhea Singha D) Pragya Kapoor

Ans: B) Kaziah Liz Mezo (Mejo) ✓ She was crowned on 23 Aug 2026 in Jaipur. Manika Vishwakarma was the **2025** winner.

43. Pointing to a photograph, a man said, "I have no brother or sister but that man's father is my father's son." Whose photograph was it?

A) His own B) His son's C) His father's D) His nephew's

Ans: B) His son's ✓ He has no siblings, so "my father's son" is himself. That makes him the father of the man in the photo.

- Q2: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2026_BWF_World_Championships
- Q3: <https://www.thepresspad.com/post/supreme-court-mgnrega-pil-vb-g-ram-g-act-minimum-wages>
- Q4: <https://ddindia.co.in/2026/08/india-japan-sign-maritime-security-pact-deepen-defence-cooperation/>
- Q5: <https://www.aljazeera.com/news/2026/8/20/bangladesh-elects-ruling-party-veteran-alamgir-as-president>
- Q6: <https://www.scobserver.in/journal/vanashakti-iii-judgement-summary/>
- Q10: <https://www.fih.hockey/events/fih-hockey-worldcup-belgium-netherlands-2026/teams>
- Q16: <https://www.bdo.in/en-gb/news/2026/india-eases-fdi-rules-under-press-note-3-with-10-per-cent-cap-for-border-country-investors>
- Q18/19: <https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2221455> · <https://vajiramandravi.com/current-affairs/union-budget-2026-27-highlights-three-kartavyas-explained/>
- Q21: <https://www.proteantech.in/articles/post-retirement-nps-entry/>
- Q22: <https://www.maritimegateway.com/dfs-launches-protection-indemnity-insurance-product-under-bharat-maritime-insurance-pool/>
- Q33: <https://www.keralatourism.org/destination/ramakkalmedu-hill-stations-kerala/53/>
- Q41: <https://www.downtoearth.org.in/energy/the-sonipat-jind-hydrogen-train-may-one-day-be-remembered-not-for-the-89-km-it-traverses-but-for-the-technological-journey-it-set-in-motion>
- Q42: <https://www.outlookindia.com/art-entertainment/miss-universe-india-2026-winner-kaziah-liz-mejo-from-kerala-wins-the-coveted-crown>